

The Future of International Law

The Uncertainty of the future of International Law cannot be more glaring than it is at the moment thanks to a host of factors ranging from the actions and inactions of world leaders, Failures of various governments, a general impunity and blatant disregard to signed conventions.

Perhaps we can blame the current state, the successes and failures of International Law on little or No punishment for offenders, or the lack/ inadequacy of mechanisms in place enforcing signed conventions, acceptance and rejection of these conventions, sensitization of the public on a general need to elect only leaders with a proven track record of adherence and commitment to pushing the Ideologies of International Law, respect for human rights amongst other things, the fact remains that International law is currently in a precarious state and it would take nothing short of a miracle to restore faith in International Law.

It goes without saying that International Law has suffered huge recent blows which questions its efficacy, ranging from recent Russian aggression in Ukraine violating the norms and protocols of the Geneva Convention and also the UN charter, Human rights violations in Iran, unabated Killings in Nigeria to mention but a few. These worldwide catastrophes though unfortunate successfully raises the constant question of how international law is effective or not. Is it really necessary? What does it do? Or should it be regarded and written off as a thing of the past, the questions go on and on.

To be fair, it is salient that we put into consideration the seeming double standards of International law/the international community, the loud silence which indirectly screams a really loud approval to a lot of violations, Israel and Palestine's unending shelling, endangering and ending the lives of millions over time, China's violations, North Korea's unnecessary continual show of force and the debatable **veto power** enjoyed by **the big five** honored with a permanent seat on the UN security Council regardless of their crimes with no one to hold them responsible. The obvious question then becomes "**Is international law for the weak?**"

On the one hand, it would be safe to assume that the future would be just as the present for international law where stronger countries need no justification to attack other weaker countries at will as long as they believe themselves to be doing the Lord's work, on the other hand the future could be worse where the idea of international law has successfully been so ridiculed and written off thereby leading to its extinction. Both are possibilities but here goes my honest opinion.

Trial and error, constant learning, correction of past mistakes, learning from and improving on them has led the world to its present state of never-before-seen breakthroughs in all facets of life. Its technological advancements, medical breakthroughs to mention but a few have all seen recent drastic improvements leading to a much better life for humans, the question then becomes, "**why not international law?**"

As much as it is easier to focus on every good thing that has been achieved and finding ways to move forward, taking a minute to reflect on the negatives shouldn't be ruled out. The idea of the veto power of **the big 5** should be revisited, paving way for a possible reform that makes it possible for everyone to be held accountable, a reform that most importantly reflects formerly ignored parties won't be a terrible idea either.

The world is constantly changing and I believe that international law amongst other things should change to meet the demands of the ever-changing world, it then is necessary to clearly state that the future can either be **non-existent, bleak or very bright** depending on the amount of work put in. We can either have ourselves a lawless world where it is a free for all or one in which there are systems in place with laws guiding and protecting as is needed.

To conclude, utmost promotion and respect for internationally acceptable standards of human rights, global acceptance of international sovereignty, boundaries and differences should be prioritized, furthermore, an approach that doesn't in any way look or seem to undermine individual sovereignty of different countries, which also doesn't show a preference or favoring one country over another should be adopted. To meet the demands of the ever-changing world, **International law has to constantly change.**